

Cross-Border Bill Pay

Turning remittance into direct, purpose-built bill payments

DESIGN STRATEGIST

DESIGN LEAD

FINTECH

0→1 PRODUCT

Draft for portfolio review — trim and tighten before publishing as a live case-study page.

01 Summary

Migrants and expats send ~30% of their remittances toward bills back home — through indirect, fragmented processes. I led the UX strategy and design for Western Union's first direct **Cross-Border Bill Pay** experience, replacing a legacy, low-adoption product (Quick Pay) with a modern, biller-network-backed flow — piloting in the E1 Canada app with a clear path to scale globally.

02 My Role

Design Strategist & Lead — owned the end-to-end UX strategy and design leadership: framed the opportunity, defined the vision narrative and guiding principles, led the competitive analysis, designed the core flows and high-fidelity prototype, and partnered with Product, partner-integration, Compliance, and Engineering to shape the phased roadmap.

03 The Problem

- **Senders** had no way to pay a bill directly — they had to trust receivers to complete payment after funds landed.
- **Receivers** relied on manual, cash-based, or fragmented local processes, often missing due dates.
- Neither side had visibility into whether or when a bill was actually paid — low transparency, low trust.
- A prior attempt (Quick Pay) failed to scale due to a cumbersome biller-setup process and weak UX.

Opportunity: ~\$170B in addressable transaction volume globally, ~\$25–30M in annual revenue potential — concentrated in corridors like US→Mexico, US→India, and UAE→Philippines.

03b Business Goals

From the presentation deck

- Capture a \$25–\$30M annual revenue opportunity (2-year projection)
- Position Western Union as a market leader in cross-border bill pay
- Deliver a secure & transparent, end-to-end bill pay experience
- Position bill pay as a high-frequency, essential service — not a one-off transaction
- Build a scalable, global bill pay capability
- Drive organic revenue growth

04 My Approach

1 Reframed the problem as a strategist

Treated bill pay as its own first-class journey — "pay the bill directly," not "send money and hope" — anchoring every downstream design decision.

2 Competitive & experience benchmarking

Teardown across global players (Wise, Xoom by PayPal, Careem Pay, Comera Pay) and Canada-specific products (PaySimply, Beacon) to define "best-in-class": global biller coverage, a simple/fast/trusted experience, low cost & risk, localized payment options, simpler biller onboarding, robust reconciliation, and compliance built into the flow.

3 Grounded the vision in real personas

Built 5 scenario narratives (migrant worker, student abroad, supporting sibling, busy professional, underbanked receiver) to pressure-test design against real friction.

4 Defined 4 design principles for a scalable platform

Radical transparency · Purpose-built flows · Sender-receiver collaboration · Built to scale, tailored locally — used as the north star for engineering and compliance throughout build.

5 Designed the core end-to-end flow

Led wireframes and a high-fidelity prototype across two journeys — the **first-time user** (never paid via WU) and the **returning user** (has paid before) — covering biller selection, bill discovery & linking, transparent fee/FX breakdown, localized pay-in, and confirmation/reminders.

6 Partnered across the org

Worked with Product on objectives/hypotheses, partner teams on biller-catalog integration, Compliance on corridor/biller whitelisting, and Engineering on a phased delivery roadmap.

05 Key Design Decisions

- **Transparency-first checkout:** every screen shows bill due amount, FX rate, fee breakdown, and total before commit.
- **Progressive biller discovery:** search/filter by country, category, and name — scales to thousands of billers.
- **Two tailored onboarding paths:** distinct flows for first-time vs. returning users, so repeat payers skip steps they've already done.
- **Design for the underbanked, not just digital-native:** OCR "photograph your bill" path for less tech-savvy users.
- **Compliance embedded, not bolted on:** corridors/biller types filtered at the front end per Risk & Compliance rules — invisible to users, critical to architecture.

o5b Phased Roadmap

From the presentation deck

Phase 1 — Baseline experience

- Pay a new bill, for new & existing users
- Bill Pay homepage; bill search, selection, fetch & pay (domestic & cross-border)
- Transaction history, track a transfer, FAQs, loyalty program

Phase 2 — Advanced bill management

- Auto-fetch new bills for existing users based on prior payment details, with proactive notification
- AutoPay — invoke users to set up recurring payments
- Gmail/SMS read access (one-time consent) to auto-fetch bills from issuer emails

o6 Outcomes / What Success Looks Like

Framed as hypotheses at time of writing — replace with real metrics post-launch.

≥10%

Eligible users complete a bill payment within 90 days of onboarding

>25%

Improvement in repeat payment rate via predictive reminders & autopay

≥40%

Increase in repeat bill payments via saved billers



North Star: number of bills paid per month (domestic + international)

o7 Visuals to Pull from Figma

- Vision/scenario board (the 5 personas) — strong storytelling opener
- Competitive benchmarking snapshot — shows strategic rigor
- Core flow: biller search → selection → bill fetch → fee breakdown → confirmation
- Guiding principles summary slide (if visual)

Source: UXD-2261 | Global E1 | Cross-Border & Domestic Bill Pay (FigJam)

o8 Notes for Final Case Study Page

- Keep to 4–5 sections max: Problem → My Role/Approach → Key Decisions → Outcomes (matches existing case-study template)
- Lead with the "Ravi" or "Ana" scenario as a 2-line human hook before the metrics
- Emphasize **strategist + lead** framing explicitly — this is a stronger "strategy" story than the execution-heavy case studies
- Strip internal codenames and any Jira/BRD links before publishing publicly